

Diagonal multiple alignments

All fixed orders, column counts and inverse thresholds

Report 177 OEIS A262810

3 October 2026

Abstract

We study binary matrices with n labelled rows, every row sum n , ordered nonzero columns, and no prescribed number of columns. Their number is OEIS A262810. We prove a constructive all-fixed-orders expansion, uniformly with every fixed number of real marking derivatives. Centering the roots of a falling factorial explains why only powers of n^{-2} occur after a natural gamma normalization. Three correction polynomials are explicit. The column count has a Gaussian limit on scale n with an essential $n/4$ centering shift. Substituting $k = n$ in the classical fixed- k alignment equivalent misses a factor $e^{-1/12}$. A Lambert- W inverse expansion gives a boundary-safe two-ceiling enclosure. The leading diagonal equivalent is credited to Kotěšovec (2016); the exact alignment family and fixed-dimensional asymptotic are classical. Exact rational finite checks accompany the analytic proof.

[write] **Status and trust boundary, added 7 October 2026, batch 109.** This is bundle Report 177 of an external AI-assisted research session, filed in ProveIt as the single-source research report **a262810-diagonal-alignments** (provenance, the sources as the write read them, what was checked, relation to the repository, the collected non-claims and the reading conventions are in Section 1.1). It is unrefereed and not formalized. Its author line reads “Report 177 OEIS A262810” and its PDF title and author fields are empty: it names no person or tool. *What rests on what.* Theorems 1.1, 1.3, 8.1 and 8.2, Corollary 1.2 and Proposition 7.1 have conventional proofs in the text: the positive binomial-power representation, Euler–Maclaurin with a vanishing boundary, gamma moment expansions after centring the roots, Stirling’s series, the real moment-generating-function limit theorem, and implicit differentiation with Lagrange inversion. The explicit L_1, L_2, L_3 and C_1, C_2, C_3 are outputs of a finite rational algorithm (Section 5), checked by the shipped verifier and rederived numerically by the write. The leading diagonal equivalent is Kotěšovec’s (2016), the exact family and the fixed-dimensional asymptotic are classical (Griggs–Hanlon–Odlyzko–Waterman, Pemantle–Wilson, Eger), and the unmarked relation of Section 9 is recorded in the OEIS. The write adds Remarks 1.4 and 8.3 (the OEIS entries quoted and the b-file compared; the inverses against the transseries volume) and dated notes. No statement, proof or number of the source was changed.

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1 The objects and the principal results

For $n \geq 1$, let $\mathcal{A}_n$ be the finite set of binary matrices with n labelled rows, row sums all n , and no zero column. Column order matters. If $\ell(M)$ denotes the number of columns, set

$$A_n(u) = \sum_{M \in \mathcal{A}_n} u^{\ell(M)}, \quad a_n = A_n(1), \quad N = n^2.$$

Thus $n \leq \ell(M) \leq n^2$. An alignment column records which of n strings advances at that position. The objects are global positional alignments of strings of length n ; no letter identities, scores, or optimality condition enter the count. The diagonal a_n is A262810, in the array A262809 [1, 2].

Throughout, a fixed order means an integer chosen before $n \rightarrow \infty$. All asymptotic constants may depend on that order and on a specified compact parameter interval. No effective onset or numerical remainder constant is asserted.

For $u > 0$, put

$$\lambda(u) = \log(1 + u^{-1}), \quad \mathcal{B}_n(u) = \frac{\Gamma(N+1)}{(1+u)\Gamma(n+1)^n \lambda(u)^{N+1}} \exp\left(-\frac{n-1}{2}\lambda(u) - \frac{\lambda(u)^2}{24}\right). \quad (1)$$

Theorem 1.1 (Uniform marked expansion). *There are rational polynomials $L_j(z)$, constructible at every order, such that for every $J, r \geq 0$ and compact $U \subset (0, \infty)$,*

$$\left\| \log \frac{A_n(u)}{\mathcal{B}_n(u)} - \sum_{j=1}^J \frac{L_j(\lambda(u))}{N^j} \right\|_{C^r(U)} = O_{J,r,U}(N^{-J-1}). \quad (2)$$

Here the norm is the maximum of the suprema of derivatives of orders $0, \dots, r$. In particular,

$$L_1(z) = \frac{z^4}{2880}, \quad (3)$$

$$L_2(z) = \frac{z^4(693 - z^2)}{181440}, \quad (4)$$

$$L_3(z) = \frac{z^4(3z^4 + 3200z^2 + 493920)}{29030400}. \quad (5)$$

Only integer powers of $N^{-1} = n^{-2}$ occur in this normalization.

The statement is an asymptotic family: it does not assert convergence of the infinite series. Section 4 supplies the growing-degree lattice and differentiated remainder arguments; Section 5 makes the coefficient construction explicit.

At $u = 1$ write $\lambda = \log 2$ once and for all. The leading equivalent recorded in A262810 by Václav Kotěšovec on 23 March 2016 is

$$K_n = \frac{n^{n^2-n/2+1}}{e^{1/12} 2^{n+\lambda/24} \pi^{(n-1)/2} \lambda^{n^2+1}}. \quad (6)$$

Its factors $e^{-1/12}$ and $e^{-\lambda^2/24}$ are part of that credited equivalent.

Corollary 1.2 (Corrections to the credited equivalent). *For every fixed J , $\log(a_n/K_n) = \sum_{j=1}^J C_j n^{-2j} + O(n^{-2J-2})$. The first three logarithmic coefficients are*

$$C_1 = \frac{\lambda^4 + 248}{2880}, \quad (7)$$

$$C_2 = -\frac{\lambda^6 - 693\lambda^4 + 144}{181440}, \quad (8)$$

$$C_3 = \frac{3\lambda^8 + 3200\lambda^6 + 493920\lambda^4 - 63360}{29030400}. \quad (9)$$

The first three ordinary multiplicative coefficients are respectively C_1 , $C_2 + C_1^2/2$, and $C_3 + C_1C_2 + C_1^3/6$.

Let L_n be the number of columns under the uniform law on $\mathcal{A}_n$.

Theorem 1.3 (Column count). *Set $\sigma^2 = (1 - \lambda)/(4\lambda^2) > 0$. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}L_n = \frac{n^2}{2\lambda} + \frac{n}{4} + \left(\frac{1}{2\lambda} - \frac{3}{4} + \frac{\lambda}{24}\right) - \frac{\lambda^3}{1440n^2} + O(n^{-4}), \quad (10)$$

$$\text{Var}(L_n) = \sigma^2 n^2 - \frac{n}{8} + \left(\sigma^2 - \frac{7 + \lambda}{48}\right) + \frac{3\lambda^2 + \lambda^3}{2880n^2} + O(n^{-4}), \quad (11)$$

$$\frac{L_n - n^2/(2\lambda) - n/4}{n} \implies \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2). \quad (12)$$

All fixed cumulants have constructive expansions by differentiating (2). Centering only by $n^2/(2\lambda)$ changes the limiting mean in (12) to $1/4$.

Remark 1.4 ([write] The OEIS entries, quoted, 7 October 2026). The entries were read on 7 October 2026 in the OEIS internal format; the quotations are verbatim.

- (a) A262810 (revision #19, 12 July 2018), offset 0, by Alois P. Heinz (2 October 2015): “Number of lattice paths from $\{n\}^n$ to $\{0\}^n$ using steps that decrement one or more components by one.”; data 1, 1, 13, 16081, 5552351121, ... (9 terms); formulas “ $a(n) = A262809(n, n)$.” and “ $a(n) \sim n^2(n^2 - n/2 + 1) / (\exp(1/12) * 2^{(n + \log(2)/24)} * \text{Pi}^{((n-1)/2)} * \log(2)^{(n^2+1)})$.” – *Vaclav Kotesovec*, Mar 23 2016”, which is (6) exactly; a b-file “Table of n , $a(n)$ for $n = 0..25$ ” (Heinz). A path is a sequence of nonempty sets of coordinates to decrement, that is, of nonzero binary columns with row sums n : the entry’s definition is the source’s.
- (b) A262809 (revision #59, 30 May 2026): “Number $A(n, k)$ of lattice paths from $\{n\}^k$ to $\{0\}^k$ using steps that decrement one or more components by one; square array $A(n, k)$, $n \geq 0$, $k \geq 0$, read by antidiagonals.”; comments “Also, $A(n, k)$ is the number of alignments for k sequences of length n each (Slowinski 1998).” and “ $d(k) = (2^{(1/k)} - 1)^{-k}$.” – *David Bevan*, Apr 07 2022” (the growth rate of (38)), Kotěšovec’s row and column asymptotics (23 March 2016); formula “ $A(n, k) = \text{Sum}_{i \geq 0} \text{binomial}(i, n) k/2^{(i+1)}$.” – *Peter Bala*, Jan 30 2018”, which is (14) at $u = 1$.
- (c) A316674 (revision #27, 4 November 2021): formula “ $A(n, k) = A262809(n, k) * A011782(n)$ for $k > 0$, $A(n, 0) = 1$.”.
- (d) A316677 (revision #8, 10 July 2018), which the source could not fetch: “Number of paths from $\{0\}^n$ to $\{n\}^n$ that always move closer to $\{n\}^n$.”, with the formula “ $a(n) = A262810(n) * \text{ceiling}(2^{(n-1)}) = A262810(n) * A011782(n)$.” So the unmarked diagonal relation of Section 9 is recorded in A316677 itself.

The b-files. The write computed a_n , $0 \leq n \leq 25$, exactly from Howroyd’s formula in A262809 (inner alternating sums first), a route different from the source’s difference table: all 26 terms of the A262810

b-file agree, the sequence is strictly increasing from $n = 1$, and all 26 terms of the A316677 b-file equal $2^{n-1}a_n$ ($n \geq 1$). No entry states a correction to Kotěšovec’s equivalent; nothing was submitted to the OEIS. (Qualified after the independent check of 7 October 2026: Howroyd’s formula is the inclusion–exclusion double sum of (15) summed in the other order, so it is the same identity, not a different route. The check confirmed all 26 terms by Bala’s positive sum, (14) at $u = 1$, with a certified rational tail bound, which is a different identity.)

1.1 Provenance, sources and reading conventions

[write] **Added 7 October 2026, batch 109.** *Provenance.* This report is Report 177 of the session bundle that ProveIt’s docs/incoming intake processed as batch 109: the archive `Diagonal_Sequence_Alignments_Asymptotics_and_Inverses_Source.zip` (1,120,000 bytes, SHA-256 `ce7560445477...ecbecaf8cef9b4e`, 21 files, no wrapper directory), arrival commit `60f54ea06`, placed in `f7e9e5c2f`. The text is the delivered `report.tex` (572 lines, dated 3 October 2026), shipped as `article.tex`; the delivered README calls it “byte-identical to the separately delivered `Report177.tex`”, a file that is not in the archive. The programs are shipped under `code/`, the frozen results, `BIBLIOGRAPHY.json` and two `generated/` records under `data/`, and `README_CODE.md` and `source_audit.md` at the root (the report README maps every name). Not shipped, and retrievable from the arrival commit: the delivered 14-page `Report177.pdf`; the checksum manifest `SHA256SUMS.json` (20 entries, verified at placement); the delivered README, replaced by the report README; and three `generated/` files that are byte copies of shipped ones. The package records no ProveIt commit and names no repository path; it carries no “prepared for private review” line and no personal data. It is a single-source report, so no merge choice was made. The write prefixed the 61 delivered labels with `dma:` and updated the 45 references to them; it added this subsection, the notes marked [write] and Remarks 1.4 and 8.3, each the last statement of its section, and inserted nothing before a delivered display or statement, so every theorem, section and equation of the source keeps its delivered number. In the preamble it loads `array`, for the table below.

The sources, as the write read them (7 October 2026).

- OEIS A262810, A262809, A316674 and A316677 in the internal format, and the b-files of A262810 and A316677 (Remark 1.4).
- Eger [5], arXiv:1511.00622v2 (24 July 2016), Section 5.5: the inclusion–exclusion formula, the positive sum (credited there to a comment in A126086) and the fixed-dimensional equivalent (credited to Griggs–Hanlon–Odlyzko–Waterman and Raichev–Wilson); and Section 5.6, which states the unmarked relation $\tilde{A}_n(1) = 2^{n-1}a_n$ for every number of sequences, citing E. Duchi and R. A. Sulanke, “The 2^{n-1} factor for multi-dimensional lattice paths with diagonal steps”, *Sém. Lothar. Combin.* 51 (2004), B51c (note at the end of Section 9).
- The transseries volume `Analysis/Transseries/docs/series-and-transseries/Transseries_And_Inversion/transseries_and_inversion.tex`: `p0:def:three-inverses`, `p0:thm:staircase`, `p0:thm:lambert-core`, `p0:prop:factorial-core`, `p0:thm:core-reversion`, `plt:def:lw-monomial-log-datum` and `plt:thm:lw-template`, read for Remark 8.3.
- Not read by the write: Griggs–Hanlon–Odlyzko–Waterman [3], Pemantle–Wilson [4], the Duchi–Sulanke paper and Slowinski’s; the source’s account of the first two is reported, not confirmed. The write checked (38) numerically instead: $A(n, k)/G(n, k) = 0.99707, 0.99853$ ($k = 2$; $n = 40, 80$) and $0.99461, 0.99730$ ($k = 3$), approaching one at rate about $1/n$.

What was checked at intake. The batch-109 dossier read the manuscript and found no error; with its own inclusion–exclusion it found $(\log(a_n/K_n) - C_1n^{-2} - C_2n^{-4} - C_3n^{-6})n^8 = 0.01450, 0.01385, 0.01374$ at $n = 8, 16, 24$, mean and variance errors times n^4 bounded, $(\log(a_n/G(n, n)) + 1/12)n^2$ approaching 0.10612999 , and $a_1, \dots, a_4$; it checked the injection of Section 8 and C_1 by hand, and reran the verifier on copies (`verify_report177.py` at orders 3 and 5 identical to `checks.json` and `checks.order5.json` after removing Windows CR bytes, `verify_manifest.py` passing; `check_reproducibility.py` fails on Windows, comparing CRLF output with the frozen file). *What the write checked.* Every proof line by line, with no mathematical error found: the generating function (13) and the positive representation (14); the identity (16); the root expansion (19) and $B_1, \dots, B_4$; the three regions of Lemma 4.1; the scaled tail (28); the odd-degree Taylor step and the cumulants of $Y - 1$; L_1 by hand; the Stirling relation (33) (at $j = 1, 2, 3$ to 64 digits); the embedding weight $\sum_{m \geq \ell} 2^{-m} \binom{m}{\ell} = 2$ and (35); $g'(0)$, $g''(0)$ and the $n/4$ shift; Proposition 7.1; x_0 from the Lambert equation; the proofs of Theorems 8.1 and 8.2

and the injection; and the shifted series of Section 9. With its own code (Python 3.14.4, mpmath 1.3.0, exact integers to $n = 25$): the b-files (Remark 1.4); $(\log(a_n/K_n) - C_1n^{-2} - C_2n^{-4} - C_3n^{-6})n^8 = 0.014181, 0.013880, 0.013777, 0.013730$ at $n = 10, 15, 20, 25$; $(\log(a_n/G(n, n)) + 1/12)n^2 = 0.1061302552, 0.1061300175, 0.1061300038$ at $n = 10, 20, 25$ against $31/360 + \lambda^2/24 = 0.1061299867\dots$; the mean and variance errors of Theorem 1.3 times n^4 ($-0.00262, -0.00259, -0.00257$ and $0.00698, 0.00689, 0.00684$ at $n = 12, 16, 20$); and the inverse diagnostics at the end of Section 8. It reran the verifier from the shipped files (README, Route B): both orders give the frozen results after removing CR bytes, and `check_reproducibility.py` fails on Windows as at intake. Finite and floating computations are observations, not certificates.

Relation to the repository. Before batch 109 no file of the repository named A262809, A316674 or A316677, and A262810 was named only in the neighbouring report `a138178-symmetric-packed-matrices`, whose source’s `SOURCES.md` read “177 (A262810 diagonal alignments)” and found “different models”; that report’s Section 1.1 and README already point to this one, so no reciprocal note is needed. The source’s audit found “no A262810/A262809 alignment entry” in the public catalogue on 3 October 2026; that was true. No result is shared with any report. No statement of this report is formalized in Lean or Rocq, and its place in the collection confers no formal status. The inverses of Section 8 are compared with the transseries volume in Remark 8.3.

[write] What is not claimed, collected from the source. No global novelty: the leading diagonal equivalent (6) is Kotěšovec’s, the exact family, the positive sum and the fixed-dimensional asymptotic are classical (Griggs–Hanlon–Odlyzko–Waterman 1990, Pemantle–Wilson 2008, Eger 2015), and the unmarked relation of Section 9 is recorded (“not as an independent discovery”); the source assessment is “bounded . . . , not a theorem of global priority or an exhaustive literature search”. No complex-parameter uniformity, local central limit theorem or Berry–Esseen rate; no effective remainder constants or onsets; no exact universal single ceiling; no convergent infinite series (of L_j or of the inverse); no exponentially improved counting. Proposition 7.1 is a nonuniformity example, “not an error in the fixed- k theorem”, and Pemantle and Wilson’s corrections of a handbook formula are unrelated. The source compared no b-file and did not inspect A316677 directly. Exact rational finite checks establish finite identities and bounds, not the analytic theorem. The write adds: its own checks are floating or finite; Remark 8.3 claims no novelty for any inversion.

Reading conventions (letters the source reuses, with the tempting false readings; no symbol of the source was renamed; symbols of the transseries volume carry the subscript “vol” in Remark 8.3).

Symbol	Meaning here (where)	Not to be read as
$\lambda, \lambda(u), \lambda(t)$	$\log 2$ from (6) on; $\log(1 + u^{-1})$ (1); $\log(1 + e^{-t})$ (34)	each other
ρ	$u/(1 + u)$ (Section 2); the homotopy parameter in the proof of Theorem 8.1	each other; the volume’s ρ_{vol}
h, H_q, H_J, H_0	$(n - 1)/2$; the exponentiated coefficients (Section 4) and (30); the inverse surrogate (39)	each other; the volume’s h_{vol}
q	$m - h$ (Section 3); a Taylor index (Section 4); $M - h$ in (36)	each other
$B_r(N), B_s(x), B_{2s}$	centred power sums (19); Bernoulli polynomials and numbers	each other; the volume’s B_{vol}
K_n, K, C_j, C_J	Kotěšovec’s equivalent (6); the inverse order of Theorem 8.1; the corrections (7)–(9); the constant of Theorem 8.2	each other
$L_j, \mathbb{L}_n$	correction polynomials (2); the column count	each other; the volume’s L_{vol}
$N, \mathcal{N}$	n^2 ; the normal law	each other
a, a_n, a_j	$\lambda^2/24$ (27); the counts; the roots $h - j$	each other; the volume’s a_{vol}
r_m, r, R_j, R	ratios t_{m+1}/t_m (Section 2) and remainders in the proof of Theorem 8.2; derivative orders; the coefficients (31); an integer order in Lemma 4.1	each other
t, t_m, T	the mgf variable; series terms (Section 2); the threshold logarithm (Section 8)	each other; the volume’s t_{vol}
M, M	the auxiliary integer (35); a fixed order in Lemma 4.1	each other
$F(v), F_0, F_J,$ $G_N, G(n, k)$	the grid recursion (17); the inverse surrogates (39); $\Gamma(N + 1)/\lambda^{N+1}$; the fixed- k equivalent (38)	each other
$p, p_n(m)$	$J - q$ (Section 4) and $2J + 2$ (proof of Theorem 8.2); $\binom{m}{n}^n$	each other
μ_r, κ_r	moments and cumulants of $Y - 1$	the volume’s $\mu_{\text{vol}}, \kappa_{\text{vol}}$
$\nu(T), D, W$	the integer threshold; $(F'_0)^{-1} d/dx$; the Lambert function	the volume’s $\nu_{\mathcal{A}}$

2 Exact constructions and finite certificates

For arbitrary row sums $n_1, \dots, n_k$, the generating function of a sequence of nonzero binary columns is

$$\sum_{n_1, \dots, n_k \geq 0} A(n_1, \dots, n_k; u) x_1^{n_1} \cdots x_k^{n_k} = \frac{1}{1 - u(\prod_{i=1}^k (1 + x_i) - 1)}. \quad (13)$$

For $u > 0$, expanding near $x = 0$ gives the positive representation

$$A(n_1, \dots, n_k; u) = \frac{1}{1 + u} \sum_{m \geq 0} \left(\frac{u}{1 + u} \right)^m \prod_{i=1}^k \binom{m}{n_i}. \quad (14)$$

The unmarked identity is classical; Eger [5, Section 5.5] gives both this and inclusion–exclusion. It is also recorded for A262809 [2]. The marking follows the same column construction.

Let $p_n(m) = \binom{m}{n}^n$. Inclusion–exclusion over columns unused by every row gives

$$d_{n,j} = [u^j] A_n(u) = \Delta^j p_n(0) = \sum_{i=0}^j (-1)^{j-i} \binom{j}{i} \binom{i}{n}^n, \quad A_n(u) = \sum_{j=0}^N d_{n,j} u^j. \quad (15)$$

The signed formula is evaluated exactly with integers, not by cancellation of floating-point approximations. A genuinely positive independent construction expands p_n in the binomial basis using

$$\binom{m}{r} \binom{m}{n} = \sum_{j=\max(r,n)}^{r+n} \binom{j}{r} \binom{r}{r+n-j} \binom{m}{j}. \quad (16)$$

Indeed, choose an r -set and an n -set in an m -set by first choosing their j -element union, then the r -set, then the $r+n-j$ intersection. Repeating (16) n times yields the same $d_{n,j}$ with positive integer operations.

A third, small-instance recursion is

$$F(v) = \sum_{\emptyset \neq S \subseteq \text{supp}(v)} F(v - \mathbf{1}_S), \quad F(0) = 1, \quad (17)$$

where v is the vector of remaining row sums. The first nonzero column determines the summand, proving the recursion.

For a rational mark $u > 0$, write $\rho = u/(1+u)$ and

$$t_m = \frac{\rho^m}{1+u} \binom{m}{n}^n, \quad \frac{t_{m+1}}{t_m} = \rho \left(\frac{m+1}{m+1-n} \right)^n =: r_m \quad (m \geq n).$$

The ratios decrease to $\rho < 1$. If $r_M < 1$ and $S_M = \sum_{m=n}^M t_m$, then

$$S_M \leq A_n(u) \leq S_M + \frac{t_M r_M}{1 - r_M}. \quad (18)$$

Every endpoint is rational. These finite certificates check exact identities; they are logically separate from the analytic asymptotic theorem.

3 Centering the growing degree

Put

$$h = \frac{n-1}{2}, \quad q = m - h, \quad a_j = h - j \quad (0 \leq j < n), \quad P_n(q) = \prod_{j=0}^{n-1} (q + a_j)^n.$$

The multiset of roots is symmetric. For $q > h$,

$$P_n(q) = q^N \exp \left(- \sum_{r \geq 1} B_r(N) q^{-2r} \right), \quad B_r(N) = \frac{n}{2r} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} (h - j)^{2r}. \quad (19)$$

Also $0 \leq P_n(q) \leq q^N$ for $q \geq h$, by pairing $q + a$ with $q - a$. At $q = h$, the polynomial has a zero of multiplicity n .

Let $B_s(x)$ be the Bernoulli polynomial, distinguished typographically from $B_r(N)$. The power sum is

$$\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} (h - j)^{2r} = \frac{B_{2r+1}((n+1)/2) - B_{2r+1}((1-n)/2)}{2r+1}.$$

It is an odd polynomial in n , of degree $2r + 1$, as follows either by replacing n with $-n$ or by Bernoulli reflection. Thus $B_r(N)$ is a rational polynomial of degree $r + 1$ in N . In particular,

$$\begin{aligned} B_1(N) &= N(N - 1)/24, \\ B_2(N) &= N(N - 1)(3N - 7)/960, \\ B_3(N) &= N(N - 1)(3N^2 - 18N + 31)/8064, \\ B_4(N) &= N(N - 1)(5N^3 - 55N^2 + 239N - 381)/92160. \end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

This parity is the source of the all-orders n^{-2} structure; observing the first coefficients alone would not prove it.

4 Uniform analytic remainder bounds

Fix $0 < \alpha \leq \lambda \leq \beta < \infty$. Constants below are uniform on this interval. Define

$$f(q) = e^{-\lambda q} P_n(q) \mathbf{1}_{q \geq h}, \quad G_N(\lambda) = \frac{\Gamma(N + 1)}{\lambda^{N+1}}, \quad I_n(\lambda) = \int_h^\infty e^{-\lambda q} P_n(q) dq.$$

The lattice is $\mathbb{Z} - h$. Its point h has value zero; all original terms with $m < n$ vanish. Equation (14) becomes

$$A_n(u) = \frac{e^{-\lambda h}}{(1 + u)(n!)^n} \sum_{q \in \mathbb{Z} - h} f(q). \tag{21}$$

4.1 Lattice replacement with growing degree

Lemma 4.1. *For all fixed $M, r \geq 0$,*

$$\left\| \frac{\sum_{q \in \mathbb{Z} - h} f(q) - I_n(\lambda)}{G_N(\lambda)} \right\|_{C^r([\alpha, \beta])} = O_{M, r}(N^{-M}).$$

Moreover $cG_N \leq I_n \leq G_N$ with $c > 0$ independent of n and λ for large n .

Proof. For any fixed integer $R \geq 2$ and $n > R$, the cutoff at h has the boundary regularity required by Euler–Maclaurin. Its derivatives through order $R - 1$ vanish there, and its R th derivative is integrable. The periodic-Bernoulli remainder, or R integrations by parts in Poisson summation, gives

$$\left| \sum_{q \in \mathbb{Z} - h} f(q) - I_n \right| \leq c_R \|f^{(R)}\|_1. \tag{22}$$

We bound the integrated derivative in three regions; derivatives here are with respect to q .

On $\mathcal{C} = \{|q - N/\lambda| \leq \sqrt{N} \log N\}$, all $q + a_j$ are comparable to N . With $\ell = \log f$,

$$\ell' = -\lambda + n \sum_j (q + a_j)^{-1} = O(N^{-1/2} \log N), \quad \ell^{(s)} = O_s(N^{1-s}) \quad (s \geq 2).$$

For the first equality, the linear a_j term cancels; the correction to N/q is $O(N^2/q^3) = O(N^{-1})$. In Bell's derivative formula, a product with m_s factors $\ell^{(s)}$ and $\sum s m_s = R$ is at most $O_R(N^{-R/2} (\log N)^R)$. Hence

$$|f^{(R)}| \leq c_R N^{-R/2} (\log N)^R f \quad \text{on } \mathcal{C}. \tag{23}$$

The logarithm of $P_n(q)/q^N$ is bounded between fixed constants there by (19). A gamma variable of shape $N + 1$ and rate λ lies in $\mathcal{C}$ with probability tending to one uniformly. This proves $I_n \geq cG_N$; the upper bound follows from $P_n \leq q^N$.

On $[N/(2\lambda), 2N/\lambda] \setminus \mathcal{C}$, the same logarithmic derivatives are bounded by fixed powers of N . The gamma Chernoff bound gives a loss $\exp(-c \log^2 N)$ after integration, smaller than N^{-A} for every fixed A . For completeness, the bound follows from the gamma mgf $(1 - t/\lambda)^{-(N+1)}$ by exponential Markov inequality, optimizing t ; on compact relative deviations the rate is quadratic.

On the two far tails, do not use singular logarithmic derivatives near h . Differentiating the product of its N nonnegative linear factors yields

$$|f^{(R)}(q)| \leq \sum_{j=0}^R \binom{R}{j} \lambda^{R-j} (N)_{\underline{j}} e^{-\lambda q} (q+h)^{N-j}. \quad (24)$$

Integrate each term after the substitution $z = q + h$. If Z_j has gamma shape $N - j + 1$ and rate λ , after factoring out $\binom{R}{j}$, the corresponding integral divided by G_N is exactly

$$\lambda^R e^{\lambda h} \mathbb{P}(Z_j \text{ belongs to the shifted integration region}), \quad (25)$$

since $(N)_{\underline{j}} \Gamma(N - j + 1) / \Gamma(N + 1) = 1$. In the lower tail the upper endpoint is $N/(2\lambda) + h$; in the upper tail the lower endpoint is $2N/\lambda + h$. For fixed j these probabilities are $O(e^{-cN})$. The prefactor $e^{\lambda h} = e^{O(\sqrt{N})}$ is absorbed. This integrated estimate avoids a false pointwise comparison at the cutoff.

Combining the regions proves

$$\frac{\|f^{(R)}\|_1}{G_N} \leq c_R N^{-R/2} (\log N)^R + O_A(N^{-A}).$$

Choose $R > 2M$ and then slightly larger to absorb logarithms. For r parameter derivatives, differentiation inserts $(-q)^r$; Leibniz bounds for the q -derivatives of $q^r f$ lose at most fixed powers N^r . Derivatives of G_N^{-1} likewise lose only fixed powers of N . Increase R again. The zero at the boundary retains sufficient order for each fixed r , completing the C^r assertion. $\square$

4.2 The gamma expectation and its differentiated expansion

Set $\varepsilon = N^{-1}$ and let Y have gamma shape $N + 1$ and rate N , so its law is independent of λ . On $y > \lambda h/N$ put

$$Q_N(y, \lambda) = \prod_j \left(1 + \frac{\lambda a_j}{Ny}\right)^n,$$

and put it equal to zero below that cutoff. Scaling $q = Ny/\lambda$ gives

$$I_n/G_N = \mathbb{E} Q_N(Y, \lambda). \quad (26)$$

Fix a neighborhood V of 1 with compact closure in $(0, \infty)$. On V , the series (19) is absolutely convergent and

$$\log Q_N(y, \lambda) = -\frac{a}{y^2} + \sum_{j=1}^J \varepsilon^j g_j(y; \lambda) + O(\varepsilon^{J+1}), \quad a = \lambda^2/24. \quad (27)$$

The expansion through ε^J has remainder $O(\varepsilon^{J+1})$ in every fixed mixed y, λ derivative norm. Indeed,

$$B_r(N)(Ny/\lambda)^{-2r} \leq \frac{N}{2r} \left(\frac{\lambda h}{Ny}\right)^{2r},$$

so the tail starting at $r = J + 2$ is $O(N^{-J-1})$. Derivatives contribute only fixed powers of r and bounded reciprocal powers of y, λ , absorbed by the geometric tail. Every retained B_r is a polynomial in N .

The expectation outside V is negligible in every required fixed λ derivative norm. Here is an integrated bound that also handles the moving cutoff. For a derivative order s , the product rule and $|a_j| \leq h$ give, on the positive domain,

$$|\partial_\lambda^s Q_N(y, \lambda)| \leq (N)_s \left(\frac{h}{Ny} \right)^s \left(1 + \frac{\beta h}{Ny} \right)^{N-s}.$$

Multiplication by the gamma density and the substitution $z = y + \beta h/N$ bound each tail integral by

$$h^s e^{\beta h} \mathbb{P}\{\text{Gamma}(N - s + 1, N) \text{ lies in the shifted tail}\}. \quad (28)$$

The factorials cancel exactly. Because the shift is $O(N^{-1/2})$ and V is fixed, these probabilities are $O(e^{-cN})$. Boundary terms from differentiating the cutoff vanish for $n > s$, owing to the multiplicity- n zero. This proves the differentiated tail assertion without assuming complex-parameter uniformity.

Exponentiate (27) as

$$Q_N(y, \lambda) = e^{-a/y^2} \sum_{q=0}^J H_q(y; \lambda) \varepsilon^q + O_{Cr}(\varepsilon^{J+1}) \quad (y \in V).$$

For the q th term put $p = J - q$. Taylor-expand its smooth coefficient about $y = 1$ through degree $2p + 1$. The next, even-degree absolute remainder has expectation

$$O(\mathbb{E}|Y - 1|^{2p+2}) = O(\varepsilon^{p+1}).$$

This step needs the odd degree $2p + 1$ before estimating the remainder; stopping at degree $2p$ with an absolute odd moment would not suffice for the stated order. The signed moments are exactly

$$\mu_r(\varepsilon) = \mathbb{E}(Y - 1)^r = \sum_{j=0}^r (-1)^{r-j} \binom{r}{j} \prod_{i=1}^j (1 + i\varepsilon). \quad (29)$$

Their valuation is at least $\lceil r/2 \rceil$. For example, $Y - 1$ has cumulants $\kappa_1 = \varepsilon$ and $\kappa_r = (r - 1)!(\varepsilon^{r-1} + \varepsilon^r)$ for $r \geq 2$; the moment-cumulant formula proves the valuation and the even absolute-moment estimate. Thus the degree $2p + 1$ term can be omitted from the coefficient algorithm, because it is already $O(\varepsilon^{p+1})$.

All these estimates commute with any fixed number of λ derivatives: the law of Y is independent of λ , and coefficient bounds are uniform. Taking logarithms is valid because the leading expectation e^{-a} stays bounded away from zero. Lemma 4.1, (21), and the smooth change of variable $\lambda = \log(1 + 1/u)$ prove Theorem 1.1.

5 A constructive algorithm at every fixed order

The following finite rational procedure computes $L_1, \dots, L_J$.

1. Compute $B_r(N)$ for $1 \leq r \leq J + 1$ by the Bernoulli formula in Section 3. Expand

$$- \sum_{r=1}^{J+1} B_r(\varepsilon^{-1}) \lambda^{2r} \varepsilon^{2r} y^{-2r}$$

through degree J , giving $-a/y^2 + \sum_{j=1}^J g_j \varepsilon^j$.

2. Form $H_0 = 1$ and

$$H_j = \frac{1}{j} \sum_{s=1}^j s g_s H_{j-s}. \quad (30)$$

3. Compute the moments (29) through degree $2J$ and form, discarding powers above ε^J ,

$$\sum_{q=0}^J \varepsilon^q \sum_{r=0}^{2(J-q)} \frac{\mu_r(\varepsilon)}{r!} \left[e^a \frac{d^r}{dy^r} \{ e^{-a/y^2} H_q(y; \lambda) \} \right]_{y=1} = \sum_{j=0}^J R_j(\lambda) \varepsilon^j. \quad (31)$$

No transcendental symbolic operation is needed: start from $f = H_q$ and replace f by $\partial_y f + 2ay^{-3}f$ at each differentiation, then evaluate at $y = 1$.

4. With $R_0 = 1$, extract the logarithm by

$$L_j = R_j - \frac{1}{j} \sum_{s=1}^{j-1} s L_s R_{j-s}. \quad (32)$$

Every operation is rational polynomial or Laurent-polynomial arithmetic. The proof in Section 4 establishes the remainder at each fixed order, rather than merely identifying a formal series.

As a transparent first-order check,

$$g_1 = ay^{-2} - \frac{\lambda^4}{320} y^{-4}.$$

For $f(y) = e^{-a/y^2}$, the gamma expectation correction is $f'(1) + f''(1)/2 = e^{-a}(2a^2 - a)$. Adding $g_1(1)$ cancels the terms in a and leaves

$$L_1 = 2a^2 - \lambda^4/320 = \lambda^4/2880.$$

The supplied rational verifier implements this algorithm and checks the printed L_j .

To pass from the exact gamma carrier to (6), set $b_s = B_{2s}/(2s(2s-1))$, with B_{2s} the Bernoulli number. Stirling's expansion in $\log \Gamma(N+1) - n \log \Gamma(n+1)$ gives

$$C_j = L_j(\lambda) - b_{j+1} + \mathbf{1}_{\{j \text{ odd}\}} b_{(j+1)/2}. \quad (33)$$

The constant from $-n \log \Gamma(n+1)$ is $-1/12$. The remaining leading terms give exactly (6), including $e^{-\lambda^2/24}$. Taking sufficiently many Stirling terms proves the remainder in Corollary 1.2; (33) gives (7)–(9).

6 The complete marked law and its central limit

The polynomial (15) is the exact column-count law:

$$\mathbb{P}(L_n = j) = d_{n,j}/a_n, \quad \mathbb{E}e^{tL_n} = A_n(e^t)/A_n(1).$$

For all real t in any fixed compact interval, write $\lambda(t) = \log(1 + e^{-t})$. Taking logarithms in Theorem 1.1 gives the complete all-orders real cumulant-generating expansion

$$\begin{aligned} \log \mathbb{E}e^{tL_n} = & - (N+1) \log \frac{\lambda(t)}{\lambda} - \log \frac{1+e^t}{2} - h(\lambda(t) - \lambda) - \frac{\lambda(t)^2 - \lambda^2}{24} \\ & + \sum_{j=1}^J \frac{L_j(\lambda(t)) - L_j(\lambda)}{N^j} + O_{C^r}(N^{-J-1}). \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

The remainder vanishes at $t = 0$ and has the proved fixed derivative bounds. For a fixed positive mark u_0 , the tilted law assigning probability $u_0^{\ell(M)}/A_n(u_0)$ has the same formula with $A_n(u_0 e^t)/A_n(u_0)$. Thus (2) describes all fixed positive tilts as well as all fixed cumulants.

6.1 Direct moment identities and cancellation control

Introduce an auxiliary integer M with probability proportional to $2^{-m} \binom{m}{n}^n$. This variable is a device from the positive sum and is not the column count. Differentiating the absolutely convergent exact series in (14), then setting $u = e^t$ and $t = 0$, proves

$$\mathbb{E}L_n = \frac{\mathbb{E}M - 1}{2}, \quad \text{Var}(L_n) = \frac{\text{Var}(M) - \mathbb{E}M - 1}{4}. \quad (35)$$

There is also an exact probabilistic explanation. Sample $M = m$ with the stated mass, choose each row's n positions independently and uniformly among m columns, then delete the zero columns. For a specified length- ℓ alignment, the total embedding weight is

$$\sum_{m \geq \ell} 2^{-m} \binom{m}{\ell} = 2,$$

independent of the alignment, so deletion gives the uniform law on $\mathcal{A}_n$. Conditional on $L_n = \ell$, the difference $M - \ell$ is the sum of $\ell + 1$ independent geometric failure counts with success probability $1/2$. Therefore

$$\mathbb{E}(M \mid L_n) = 2L_n + 1, \quad \text{Var}(M \mid L_n) = 2(L_n + 1).$$

Total expectation and total variance recover (35).

For clarity, $\lambda'(0) = -1/2$ and $\lambda''(0) = 1/4$; the separate term $-\log(1 + e^t)$ contributes $-1/2$ and $-1/4$ respectively.

Put $q = M - h$. The C^2 version of the theorem justifies differentiating the normalized logarithm of its positive lattice partition function. It gives

$$\mathbb{E}q = \frac{N+1}{\lambda} + \frac{\lambda}{12} - \frac{\lambda^3}{720N} + O(N^{-2}), \quad (36)$$

$$\text{Var}(q) = \frac{N+1}{\lambda^2} - \frac{1}{12} + \frac{\lambda^2}{240N} + O(N^{-2}). \quad (37)$$

These formulas can also be obtained without differentiating a remainder: insert m and m^2 separately in the positive series, apply the same lattice estimate, then use $m = h + NY/\lambda$ in the gamma integral. The polynomial insertions preserve the Taylor proof. One must retain enough terms before subtracting the squared mean: an m^2 insertion has scale N^2 , so to get an $O(N^{-2})$ absolute remainder it suffices to keep the normalized expectation through ε^3 with remainder $O(\varepsilon^4)$, and correspondingly enough terms in the first moment and denominator. The arbitrary-order theorem allows this precision. A bare $O(N^{-2})$ normalized second-moment error would not justify the variance claim.

Now substitute $\mathbb{E}M = \mathbb{E}q + h$ and $\text{Var}(M) = \text{Var}(q)$ in (35). This proves (10)–(11), including the constant terms and the n^{-2} corrections.

6.2 A real moment-generating-function proof

For a fixed real s , take $t = s/n$ in (34). The function $g(t) = -\log(\lambda(t)/\lambda)$ satisfies

$$g'(0) = \frac{1}{2\lambda}, \quad g''(0) = \frac{1-\lambda}{4\lambda^2} = \sigma^2.$$

Hence $Ng(s/n) = sn/(2\lambda) + \sigma^2 s^2/2 + O(n^{-1})$. The h -term is

$$-h(\lambda(s/n) - \lambda) = s/4 + O(n^{-1}).$$

All other differences in (34) tend to zero. Therefore

$$\log \mathbb{E} \exp \left\{ s \frac{L_n - N/(2\lambda) - n/4}{n} \right\} \longrightarrow \frac{\sigma^2 s^2}{2}.$$

The real mgf convergence theorem proves (12). This argument requires no complex extension of the marking theorem. It provides neither a local central limit theorem nor a Berry–Esseen rate, and no such conclusion is claimed.

7 The fixed dimensional limit and the diagonal

For fixed k , let $A(n, k) = A(n, \dots, n; 1)$ with k row sums. The classical theorem of Griggs, Hanlon, Odlyzko, and Waterman [3], as displayed also by Pemantle and Wilson [4, Section 4.9] and Eger [5], is

$$A(n, k) \sim G(n, k), \quad G(n, k) = \frac{2^{(1-k^2)/(2k)} (2^{1/k} - 1)^{-kn-1}}{\sqrt{k} (\pi n)^{(k-1)/2}} \quad (n \rightarrow \infty, k \text{ fixed}). \quad (38)$$

Its quantifier on k matters.

Proposition 7.1. *Substitution $k = n$ in the fixed-dimensional leading expression gives*

$$\log \frac{a_n}{G(n, n)} = -\frac{1}{12} + \frac{31/360 + \lambda^2/24}{n^2} + O(n^{-4}), \quad \frac{a_n}{G(n, n)} \longrightarrow e^{-1/12}.$$

Proof. Use

$$\log \frac{e^z - 1}{z} = \frac{z}{2} + \frac{z^2}{24} - \frac{z^4}{2880} + O(z^6), \quad z = \lambda/n,$$

in the exact expression $G(n, n)$, and compare with (6) and C_1 in (7). The constant discrepancy is $-1/12$; the n^{-2} coefficient is $31/360 + \lambda^2/24$ after the λ^4 terms cancel. $\square$

This is a nonuniformity example, not an error in the fixed- k theorem. The previously reported typographical corrections to a Waterman handbook formula discussed in [4] are a separate matter and are not claimed here.

8 Lambert inversion with a safe integer boundary

For $\lambda = \log 2$, define

$$\begin{aligned} F_0(x) &= x^2 \log(x/\lambda), \\ H_0(x) &= -\frac{x}{2} \log x - x \log 2 - \frac{x-1}{2} \log \pi + \log x - \log \lambda - \frac{1}{12} - \frac{\lambda^2}{24}, \\ H_J(x) &= H_0(x) + \sum_{j=1}^J C_j x^{-2j}, \quad F_J(x) = F_0(x) + H_J(x). \end{aligned} \quad (39)$$

Corollary 1.2 says $\log a_n = F_J(n) + O(n^{-2J-2})$. These are smooth asymptotic surrogates, not a claimed analytic continuation of the discrete sequence.

8.1 All fixed inverse orders

The positive Lambert branch solves $W(z)e^{W(z)} = z$ for $z > 0$. The large inverse of F_0 is

$$x_0(T) = \sqrt{\frac{2T}{W(2T/\lambda^2)}}. \quad (40)$$

For large T , let $x_J(T)$ be the exact large real root of $F_J(x) = T$ and set $D = (F'_0(x))^{-1}d/dx$.

Theorem 8.1 (Constructive inverse expansion). *For every fixed $J \geq 0$ and $K \geq 1$,*

$$x_J(T) = x_0(T) + \sum_{k=1}^K \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} D^{k-1} \left(\frac{H_J(x)^k}{F'_0(x)} \right) \Big|_{x=x_0(T)} + O_{J,K}(x_0(T)^{-K}). \quad (41)$$

In particular, with the functions on the right evaluated at x_0 ,

$$x_J = x_0 - \frac{H_J}{F'_0} + \frac{H_J H'_J}{(F'_0)^2} - \frac{H_J^2 F''_0}{2(F'_0)^3} + O(x_0^{-2}). \quad (42)$$

The first correction tends to $1/4$, with logarithmic corrections.

Proof. For $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$ solve $F_0(X) + \rho H_J(X) = T$ near x_0 . Since $H_J/F'_0 = O(1)$ and $F'_0 \sim 2x \log x$, monotonicity and the intermediate value theorem give a unique root $X = x_0 + O(1)$ uniformly in ρ . The derivative $F'_0 + \rho H'_J$ remains comparable to F'_0 .

Uniformly in this neighborhood,

$$\frac{H_J^{(\ell)}}{F'_0} = O(x_0^{-\ell}) \quad (\ell \geq 1), \quad \frac{F_0^{(\ell)}}{F'_0} = O(x_0^{1-\ell}) \quad (\ell \geq 2).$$

Implicit differentiation, followed by induction, gives $\partial_\rho^k X = O_k(x_0^{1-k})$ for every fixed $k \geq 1$. In the differentiated equation the term containing the highest derivative is $(F'_0 + \rho H'_J) \partial_\rho^k X$; the other Bell-polynomial terms obey the displayed bounds and already established derivative bounds. Taylor's theorem in ρ through degree K consequently has remainder $O(x_0^{-K})$.

To compute its coefficients, make the change $w = F_0(x)$. The equation becomes $w = T - \rho H_J(F_0^{-1}(w))$. The Lagrange inversion formula applied to $F_0^{-1}(w)$ gives exactly the finite coefficients in (41); they can equivalently be obtained by successive implicit differentiation at $\rho = 0$. The first two yield (42). Finally $-H_J/F'_0 \rightarrow 1/4$. $\square$

No convergence of the infinite inverse series follows or is needed.

8.2 The integer threshold and near-boundary ambiguity

Define

$$\nu(T) = \min\{n \geq 1 : a_n \geq e^T\}.$$

The sequence is strictly increasing for positive n . To see this, add a zero row to an n -row matrix, append a column with ones in all old rows and zero in the new row, then append $n+1$ columns supported only on the new row. Every row sum becomes $n+1$. Deleting the fixed final $n+2$ columns and the new row recovers the original. This is an injection; the all-ones $(n+1) \times (n+1)$ matrix is outside its image, proving strictness.

Theorem 8.2 (Boundary-safe enclosure). *For every fixed $J \geq 0$ there exist constants $C_J > 0$ and T_J such that, with $x = x_J(T)$ and*

$$\delta_J(x) = C_J \frac{x^{-2J-3}}{\log x},$$

all $T \geq T_J$ satisfy

$$\lceil x - \delta_J(x) \rceil \leq \nu(T) \leq \lceil x + \delta_J(x) \rceil. \quad (43)$$

For large T the two integer endpoints differ by at most one. At a sequence threshold $T = \log a_n$, $x_J(T) - n = O(n^{-2J-3}/\log n)$.

Proof. Write $\log a_m = F_J(m) + r_m$ with $|r_m| \leq C m^{-p}$, $p = 2J + 2$, for all large integers m . Since $F'_J \asymp x \log x$ near x and $F_J(x) = T$, a sufficiently large fixed C_J gives, for integers $|m - x| \leq 2$,

$$m < x - \delta_J(x) \implies \log a_m < T, \quad m \geq x + \delta_J(x) \implies \log a_m \geq T.$$

First applying the same derivative bounds at neighboring integers a fixed distance from x locates the threshold in this neighborhood. Monotonicity then extends the implications to more distant integers, proving (43). The threshold-sample assertion follows by the mean value theorem. $\square$

If the two ceilings coincide, they determine the exact threshold. A universal single-ceiling formula is unwarranted when T is arbitrarily close to $\log a_n$. To use the K -term approximation (41) instead of the exact surrogate root, enlarge the radius by its error. Taking $K \geq 2J + 4$ makes $O(x_0^{-K})$ smaller than the $x^{-2J-3}/\log x$ scale. Taking only $K = 2J + 3$ does not establish this extra logarithmic gain. The constants and onsets in this enclosure are existence statements, not certified numerical thresholds.

[write] Rechecked, 7 October 2026. At the sequence thresholds $T = \log a_n$, from exact a_n and the roots x_J of $F_J(x) = T$ at 60 digits: $x_J(T) - n = 1.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$, $1.8 \cdot 10^{-10}$, $3.1 \cdot 10^{-11}$, $2.3 \cdot 10^{-12}$ ($J = 0, 1, 2, 3$) at $n = 10$, and $6.9 \cdot 10^{-7}$, $1.2 \cdot 10^{-12}$, $3.6 \cdot 10^{-14}$, $4.5 \cdot 10^{-16}$ at $n = 25$ (rounded), each below the scale $n^{-2J-3}/\log n$ of Theorem 8.2. The first correction $-H_0/F'_0$ at x_0 is about 0.33 for $n \leq 25$: its limit 1/4 (Theorem 8.1) is approached at a logarithmic rate. Observations, not tests of the asymptotic statements.

Remark 8.3 ([write] The inversions and the transseries volume, 7 October 2026). Compared, statement by statement, with the transseries volume ([Analysis/Transseries/docs/series-and-transseries/Transseries_And_Inversion/transseries_and_inversion.tex](#)); symbols of the volume carry the subscript “vol”.

- (a) *Instance.* The threshold $\nu(T)$ is the integer staircase N_* of `p0: def: three-inverses` with $A_n = \log a_n$, $n_1 = 1$ (the injection above makes a strictly increasing) and $y = T$, for $T \geq 0$; so `p0: thm: staircase(1)` gives $\nu(T) = \lceil \nu_{\mathcal{A}}(T) \rceil$ for every admissible interpolation $\mathcal{A}$. The source does not use this.
- (b) *Theorem 8.2: an analogue as stated and proved; also a consequence of `p0: thm: staircase(1)` once an interpolation is supplied.* The source brackets $\nu(T)$ directly about the root x_J of the surrogate F_J , which is not the inverse of an interpolation of the counts; the conclusion has the form of `p0: thm: staircase(2)`. A second route (added by the write): with $r_m = \log a_m - F_J(m) = O(m^{-2J-2})$ (Corollary 1.2), let $\tilde{r}$ be the piecewise-linear interpolation of (r_m) and $\mathcal{A} = F_J + \tilde{r}$ on $[m_0, \infty)$. Since $F'_J \asymp x \log x$ and $|\tilde{r}'| \leq 2 \max |r_m|$ on each unit interval, $\mathcal{A}$ is continuous and strictly increasing for a suitable m_0 , with $\mathcal{A}(m) = \log a_m$, so it is admissible with $n_1 = m_0$. For $\nu = \nu_{\mathcal{A}}(T)$ one has $F_J(\nu) - F_J(x_J) = -\tilde{r}(\nu)$, hence $|\nu - x_J| \leq |\tilde{r}(\nu)| / \min F'_J = O(x^{-2J-3}/\log x)$, which is at most $\delta_J(x)$ for a suitable C_J ; `p0: thm: staircase(1)` and the monotonicity of the ceiling give (43) for large T . Since $\nu_{\mathcal{A}}(\log a_n) = n$, the same bound gives the threshold-sample assertion, and `p0: thm: staircase(3)` adds that $n = \lfloor x_J(\log a_n) + \frac{1}{2} \rfloor$ for all large n , which the source does not state.

- (c) *Instance after a change of variable.* The Lambert start x_0 (40) is `p0:prop:factorial-core` after $X = x^2$: then $F_0 = X(\frac{1}{2} \log X - \log \lambda)$, so $\kappa_{\text{vol}} = \frac{1}{2}$, $d_{\text{vol}} = -\log \lambda$, $v = W_0(2T/\lambda^2)$ and $X = e^{v+2\log \lambda} = 2T/v$; the side condition $\kappa_{\text{vol}} \log X + d_{\text{vol}} > 0$ is $x > \lambda$. Its large- T expansion is a *formal* instance of `plt:thm:lw-template` with $Z_{\text{vol}} = \log x$, $\xi_{\text{vol}} = \log T$ and data $(\rho_{\text{vol}}, \mu_{\text{vol}}, \beta_{\text{vol}}, B_{\text{vol}}) = (2, 1, 0, \log(1 - t_{\text{vol}} \log \lambda))$, since $\log F_0 = 2Z_{\text{vol}} + \log Z_{\text{vol}} + \log(1 - \log \lambda / Z_{\text{vol}})$.
- (d) *Formal instance after a change of variable.* With $x = x_0(1+E)$, $t_{\text{vol}} = 1/x_0$ and $\ell = \log(x_0/\lambda)$, the equation $F_0(x) + H_J(x) = T$ divided by $x_0^2 \ell$ reads $\Lambda_{\text{vol}} E + h_{\text{vol}}(E) + f_{\text{vol}}(t_{\text{vol}}, E) = 0$ with $\Lambda_{\text{vol}} = 2 + 1/\ell$, $h_{\text{vol}}(u) = u^2 + \{(1+u)^2 \log(1+u) - u\}/\ell$ and $f_{\text{vol}} = H_J(x_0(1+u))/(x_0^2 \ell) \in t_{\text{vol}} R[[t_{\text{vol}}, u]]$, using $\log x_0 = \ell + \log \lambda$, over the ring R generated over $\mathbb{Q}$ by λ , $\log \lambda$, $\log \pi$, $C_1, \dots, C_J$, ℓ , ℓ^{-1} and $(2\ell + 1)^{-1}$. So the inverse expansion of Theorem 8.1 is formally `p0:thm:core-reversion`: its unique formal solution $E \in t_{\text{vol}} R[[t_{\text{vol}}]]$ is what the Lagrange terms of (41), of size $O(x_0^{1-k})$, sum to after re-expansion in t_{vol} . The analytic remainder $O(x_0^{-K})$ is the source's own.
- (e) *Not shown to be an instance.* The full surrogate equation $F_J(x) = T$ is not shown to be an instance of `plt:thm:lw-template`: in the chart of (c) the factor $1 + H_J/F_0$ is $1 + O(1/x) = 1 + O(e^{-Z_{\text{vol}}})$, not a series in $t_{\text{vol}} = 1/Z_{\text{vol}}$ with coefficients polynomial in $\log Z_{\text{vol}}$, so (H3) fails there. The write does not claim that no other chart makes it an instance.

The same holds for the nonnegative analogue, whose surrogate replaces H_J by $H_J + (x-1) \log 2$. No novelty is claimed for any of these inversions.

9 A binomial coupling for the nonnegative analogue

Let $\tilde{A}_n(u)$ count nonnegative-integer matrices with the same labelled rows and row sums, ordered columns, and no zero column. This is the diagonal A316677 of the array A316674. The already recorded unmarked relation to binary matrices is $\tilde{A}_n(1) = 2^{n-1} a_n$ [6]. We use it as a corollary of the marked exact construction, not as an independent discovery.

The column generating function replaces $\prod(1+x_i)$ by $\prod(1-x_i)^{-1}$. Hence

$$\tilde{A}_n(u) = \frac{1}{1+u} \sum_{m \geq 0} \left(\frac{u}{1+u} \right)^m \binom{m+n-1}{n}^n.$$

Shifting $k = m + n - 1$ gives the exact polynomial identity, interpreted for $u > 0$,

$$\tilde{A}_n(u) = \left(\frac{1+u}{u} \right)^{n-1} A_n(u). \quad (44)$$

The apparent negative powers cause no problem because $A_n(u)$ is divisible by u^n . Equivalently, under the uniform laws,

$$\tilde{\mathbf{L}}_n \stackrel{d}{=} \mathbf{L}_n - (n-1) + \text{Bin}(n-1, 1/2), \quad (45)$$

with the binomial variable independent of $\mathbf{L}_n$. Thus

$$\mathbb{E} \tilde{\mathbf{L}}_n = \mathbb{E} \mathbf{L}_n - (n-1)/2, \quad \text{Var}(\tilde{\mathbf{L}}_n) = \text{Var}(\mathbf{L}_n) + (n-1)/4,$$

and

$$\frac{\tilde{\mathbf{L}}_n - n^2/(2\lambda) + n/4}{n} \implies \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2).$$

All fixed-order marked expansions follow by adding $(n-1) \log((1+u)/u)$ to the binary logarithm. Likewise the logarithmic count surrogate is $F_J(x) + (x-1) \log 2$. The inverse proof applies after replacing H_J by $H_J + (x-1) \log 2$, with the same remainder scales and boundary-safe enclosure.

[write] **Added 7 October 2026.** The unmarked relation $\tilde{A}_n(1) = 2^{n-1}a_n$ is older than the OEIS entries: Eger [5, Section 5.6] states it for every number of sequences, citing Duchi and Sulanke, “The 2^{n-1} factor for multi-dimensional lattice paths with diagonal steps” (Sém. Lothar. Combin. 51 (2004), B51c), which the write did not read; whether their argument also tracks the number of steps, which would give the marked identity (44), was not checked. A316677 records the diagonal relation directly (Remark 1.4(d)). The source presents the relation as a corollary, “not as an independent discovery”, so its claims are unaffected.

10 Sources, reproducibility and remaining questions

10.1 Attribution and the scope of the source check

The leading diagonal equivalent (6) is recorded in OEIS with Kotěšovec’s 2016 attribution. The exact family and fixed-dimensional asymptotic precede this report: Griggs–Hanlon–Odlyzko–Waterman [3], Pemantle–Wilson [4], and Eger [5] are the primary sources used. The report’s work is the proved growing-diagonal expansion, its explicit corrections, the marked law and shifted Gaussian limit, the fixed-dimension substitution comparison, and the inverse construction.

The inspected OEIS entries and primary papers do not supply this collection of diagonal results. This is a bounded source assessment, not a theorem of global priority or an exhaustive literature search. A262810 cross-references both A262809 and A316677. The directly accessible A316674 page establishes the nonnegative array relation; a direct fetch of A316677 failed. The A262810 b-file also could not be retrieved, so no b-file comparison is claimed. The separate source audit records these limits and the document URLs.

[write] **Added 7 October 2026.** The write read A316677 and both b-files (Remark 1.4): the 26 terms of the A262810 b-file agree with its exact computation, so the sentences above on the failed fetch and the missing b-file comparison describe 3 October 2026. The audit’s statement that the public catalogue had no A262810/A262809 alignment entry was true then and remained true until this report (Section 1.1).

10.2 What the package verifies

The companion package contains this complete L^AT_EX source, the PDF, source metadata, and a Python standard-library verifier using exact integers and fractions. Its independent finite constructions are the positive binomial-basis multiplication (16) and the signed difference table (15); the small grid recursion (17) supplies a third check. For $1 \leq n \leq 10$ and $u = 1/2, 1, 2$, the exact rational intervals (18) enclose the finite marked polynomial, with relative tail less than 10^{-70} . The coefficient algorithm checks B_1 – B_4 , L_1 – L_3 , and C_1 – C_3 . An independent Gaussian Laplace calculation agrees with the gamma-central-moment route; the extension run checks both routes through order five. The nonnegative coupling and exact moment relations are checked separately.

The build uses an installed TeX stack, shell escape disabled, isolated temporary directories, fixed timestamps and a complete strict file manifest. Verification and negative guards run with ordinary and optimized Python. A fresh extraction can replay the verification and reproduce the artifacts under the same toolchain. No downloaded program is executed. These are arithmetic and packaging certificates; they do not replace the proof of the analytic remainders or supply effective asymptotic constants.

[write] **The shipped layout, 7 October 2026.** In ProveIt the “companion package” is not shipped as such: the PDF and the checksum manifest are not shipped, the README is replaced by the report README, the programs are under `code/` and the frozen results under `data/`, and the release-only `generated/` records are shipped only where they are not byte copies (Section 1.1). The verifier, run from the shipped files on a copy, reproduces the frozen results (the report README gives the route). The delivered programs expect the delivered layout.

10.3 Further questions

Several extensions remain open within this report’s scope.

1. Determine the largest growth regimes $k = k(n)$ for which the fixed-dimensional expression (38) remains relatively accurate, and describe the crossover to $k \asymp n$. The diagonal factor already shows that uniformity cannot extend unchanged to $k = n$.
2. Prove a local central limit theorem and an explicit convergence rate for the column count. The present real-mgf argument alone does not establish either.
3. Extract effective constants and onsets for the all-orders remainder and the inverse enclosure. The rational finite checks do not make the asymptotic constants effective.
4. Study the large-order behavior of L_j , optimal truncation, and exponentially small lattice sectors. The all-fixed-orders proof does not settle convergence, resurgence, or exponentially accurate counting.
5. Extend the uniform marked analysis to unequal row sums whose dimension also grows. This requires estimates beyond the exact symmetric falling-factorial cancellation used here.

[write] **Added 7 October 2026, under Vladimir’s standing rule of 4 October 2026.** The five questions stand as the source states them. The write found no unproved claim of the source outside them and no claim of the source that is wrong; the b-file and A316677 comparisons the source could not make are now made (notes above), and the priority of the marked coupling relative to Duchi and Sulanke is noted at the end of Section 9.

[write] **Independent check of the write, 7 October 2026.** An adversarial check made by the intake after the write (commit `b7a7eb374`) re-derived the statements marked [write] with its own code, after fetching again A262810 (revision #19), A262809 (#59), A316674 (#27), A316677 (#8), both b-files and Eger’s arXiv:1511.00622v2. *Remark 1.4.* Every quotation, revision and date confirmed; the 26 terms of the A262810 b-file equal Bala’s positive sum (exact, with a certified tail) and the inclusion–exclusion sum, the 26 terms of the A316677 b-file are $2^{n-1}a_n$, and a is strictly increasing from $n = 1$. The write’s “a route different from the source’s” is qualified there. *Sources.* Eger’s Sections 5.5 (formula (2), the A126086 sum, the equivalent credited to his [17, 28]) and 5.6 (the factor $2^{\ell-1}$ for every number of sequences, citing Duchi and Sulanke) as stated; the Duchi–Sulanke paper could again not be retrieved, so the question of the marked identity stays open. The neighbouring report’s `SOURCES.md` and Section 1.1 read as stated. *Numbers.* From exact a_n : $(\log(a_n/K_n) - \sum_{j \leq 3} C_j n^{-2j})n^8 = 0.014181, 0.013880, 0.013777, 0.013730$ ($n = 10, 15, 20, 25$); $(\log(a_n/G(n, n)) + 1/12)n^2 = 0.10613025524, 0.10613001754, 0.10613000382$ ($n = 10, 20, 25$); $A(n, k)/G(n, k) = 0.997071, 0.998534, 0.994609, 0.997301$; the mean and variance errors times n^4 ; the eight values of $x_J(\log a_n) - n$ at $n = 10, 25$ and the first inverse correction 0.33, all as stated. C_1, C_2, C_3 follow by hand from (33) with $b_1, \dots, b_4 = \frac{1}{12}, -\frac{1}{360}, \frac{1}{1260}, -\frac{1}{1680}$. *Remark 8.3.* (a)–(e) re-derived against the volume: the staircase and interpolation of (b) with (3) of `p0:thm:staircase`, the factorial-core data $\kappa_{\text{vol}} = \frac{1}{2}$, $d_{\text{vol}} = -\log \lambda$ and the template data of (c), the linear coefficient $2 + 1/\ell$ and the order-two h_{vol} of (d), and $H_J/F_0 \sim -1/(2x)$ in (e). *Provenance.* Archive facts (the three `generated/` byte copies identified), the 61 delivered label numbers and 45 references (aux of a build of the delivered text) confirmed. Apart from the qualification above, no defect was found in the write.

References

- [1] OEIS Foundation, *A262810: Number of alignments of n sequences of length n* . Formula by V. Kotěšovec, 23 March 2016. Inspected 3 October 2026. <https://oeis.org/A262810>.
- [2] OEIS Foundation, *A262809: Number of alignments of k sequences of length n* . Includes the positive-sum formula attributed to Peter Bala (2018). Inspected 3 October 2026. <https://oeis.org/A262809>.
- [3] J. R. Griggs, P. Hanlon, A. M. Odlyzko, and M. S. Waterman, On the number of alignments of k sequences, *Graphs and Combinatorics* **6** (1990), 133–146. <https://doi.org/10.1007/BF01787724>.

Author-hosted scan: <https://dornsife.usc.edu/msw/wp-content/uploads/sites/236/2023/09/msw-096.pdf>.

- [4] R. Pemantle and M. C. Wilson, Twenty combinatorial examples of asymptotics derived from multivariate generating functions, *SIAM Review* **50** (2008), 199–272, Section 4.9. <https://www.cs.auckland.ac.nz/~mcw/Research/Outputs/PeWi2008.pdf>.
- [5] S. Eger, On the number of many-to-many alignments of multiple sequences, *Journal of Automata, Languages and Combinatorics* **20**(1) (2015), 53–65; revised arXiv version (2016), Section 5.5. <https://arxiv.org/abs/1511.00622>.
- [6] OEIS Foundation, *A316674: Nonnegative matrices with no zero columns and prescribed common row sum*. The diagonal is A316677; the recorded relation to A262809 yields the diagonal factor 2^{n-1} . Inspected 3 October 2026. <https://oeis.org/A316674>. Related diagonal: <https://oeis.org/A316677>.